



FAITH FOUNDATIONS STUDY SERIES

Christian Character & Integrity Study Workbook

Becoming Trustworthy, Honest, and Whole in a Watching World - For
Ages 13-19



Ages 13-19 - Homeschool & Youth Groups

Personal Study - Small Groups - Reproducible for one household or class



HOW TO USE THIS STUDY

Getting the Most From This Workbook

Talent gets attention, but character determines whether you can be trusted with it. This six-unit study tackles the character issues teens actually face: integrity, honesty, purity, humility, and how to handle both failure and success. Honest, practical, and rooted in Scripture. For ages 13 to 19.

PROVERBS 4:23

"Above all else, guard your heart, for everything you do flows from it."

A Few Suggestions

- ☐ Find a consistent time and place. Even 15 focused minutes beats an hour you never start.
- ☐ Keep a pen in hand. Writing your answers turns reading into real thinking.
- ☐ Read each passage in your own Bible too, and note the version differences.
- ☐ Be honest in the reflection and journal sections - no one is grading you.
- ☐ If you meet with a group, come having already written your answers.
- ☐ Pray before you begin. Ask God to teach you, not just inform you.

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UNIT 1

Integrity: Whole in Public and Private

"The one whose walk is blameless... who keeps an oath even when it hurts." -
Psalm 15:2-4

Unit Overview

Integrity means being the same person when no one is watching. This unit examines honesty, consistency, and the cost of a divided life.

DEVOTIONAL

Who You Are in the Dark

Character is who you are when there are no cameras, no parents, and no consequences in sight.

PROVERBS 10:9

"Whoever walks in integrity walks securely, but whoever takes crooked paths will be found out."

Integrity is wholeness - your private self and public self are the same. A divided life is exhausting and fragile.

The internet has made it easy to be one person online and another in person. God calls us to one honest self.

Reflect

1. Where are you most tempted to live a divided life?

2. What would 'walking securely' feel like compared to hiding?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, make me one whole person - the same in the light and the dark.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

A Person of Integrity

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

DANIEL 6:3-4

"Now Daniel so distinguished himself among the administrators and the satraps by his exceptional qualities that the king planned to set him over the whole kingdom. At this, the administrators and the satraps tried to find grounds for charges against Daniel in his conduct of government affairs, but they were unable to do so. They could find no corruption in him, because he was trustworthy and neither corrupt nor negligent."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What set Daniel apart?

2. What were his rivals looking for?

3. What did they find?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

A Person of Integrity

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why couldn't his enemies find dirt on him?

2. What does 'neither corrupt nor negligent' require daily?

Application - What will I do?

1. Could people find 'no corruption' in your private life?

2. What area needs cleaning up?

WORD STUDY

Integrity

MEANING

Moral wholeness; being undivided and consistent in character, honest whether or not anyone sees.

Where It Appears

PSALM 25:21

"May integrity and uprightness protect me."

PROVERBS 11:3

"The integrity of the upright guides them."

Dig Deeper

1. How does integrity actually 'protect' a person?

2. Where is your integrity most tested - online, friendships, schoolwork?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Private Self

Where does your private self differ from your public image?

What secret habit would you be embarrassed to have exposed?

What would it take to close that gap?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

One Honest Week

Integrity is built by small, consistent choices. Try these.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Tell the full truth even when a half-truth is easier.
- ☐ Do your work honestly with no shortcuts or cheating.
- ☐ Match your online self to your real self for one week.
- ☐ Keep a promise that's become inconvenient.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 2

Honesty and the Words We Use

"The Lord detests lying lips, but he delights in people who are trustworthy." -
Proverbs 12:22

Unit Overview

Words build or destroy. This unit studies honesty, gossip, and the power of the tongue for teens navigating group chats and reputations.

DEVOTIONAL

The Weight of Words

A single sentence can lift someone up for weeks or crush them for years. Words are never neutral.

PROVERBS 18:21

"The tongue has the power of life and death, and those who love it will eat its fruit."

In an age of group chats and comments, words travel faster and hit harder than ever.

Honesty isn't only about not lying; it's about using words to give life, not death.

Reflect

1. When have your words hurt someone? When have they helped?

2. How do your online words compare to your in-person words?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, tame my tongue. Let my words give life.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Taming the Tongue

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

JAMES 3:5-6, 9-10

"Likewise, the tongue is a small part of the body, but it makes great boasts. Consider what a great forest is set on fire by a small spark. The tongue also is a fire... With the tongue we praise our Lord and Father, and with it we curse human beings, who have been made in God's likeness. Out of the same mouth come praise and cursing. My brothers and sisters, this should not be."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What small things do the spark and tongue have in common?

2. What contradiction does James point out?

3. What is his verdict?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Taming the Tongue

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why is the tongue compared to a fire?

2. How can the same mouth both bless and curse?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where do your words most need taming?

2. What would 'praise not cursing' look like in your group chats?

WORD STUDY

Truthfulness

MEANING

Speaking and living in accordance with reality; being reliable in word and deed.

Where It Appears**COLOSSIANS 3:9**

"Do not lie to each other, since you have taken off your old self."

EPHESIANS 4:15

"Speaking the truth in love, we will grow to become... Christ."

Dig Deeper

1. What is the difference between blunt honesty and 'truth in love'?

2. When is silence more honest than speaking?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Words That Build

Whose words have shaped you most - for good or ill?

Where do you struggle with gossip or exaggeration?

Who could you build up with your words this week?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

Words are especially powerful in our connected world. Be honest.

1. How is honesty harder or easier online?

2. Where does gossip sneak into our friend groups?

3. How can this group speak life to each other?

UNIT 3

Purity and Self-Control

"God gave us a spirit not of fear but of power, love and self-control." - 2 Timothy 1:7

Unit Overview

This unit addresses desires, discipline, and purity of heart and body with honesty and grace, not shame.

DEVOTIONAL

Ruled or Ruling

You either master your desires or they master you. There's no neutral setting.

PROVERBS 25:28

"Like a city whose walls are broken through is a person who lacks self-control."

A city without walls is defenseless. A life without self-control is exposed to whatever pushes hardest.

Self-control isn't about hating your desires; it's about not being enslaved by them. And it's a gift the Spirit grows in you.

Reflect

1. Where do your desires currently 'rule' you?

2. What would freedom in that area look like?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, build strong walls in me. Free me to rule my desires rather than be ruled.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Flee and Pursue

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

1 CORINTHIANS 6:18-20

"Flee from sexual immorality. All other sins a person commits are outside the body, but whoever sins sexually, sins against their own body. Do you not know that your bodies are temples of the Holy Spirit, who is in you, whom you have received from God? You are not your own; you were bought at a price. Therefore honor God with your bodies."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What are we told to do about sexual immorality?

2. What are our bodies called?

3. Why are we 'not our own'?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Flee and Pursue

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Paul say to 'flee' rather than resist head-on?

2. How does 'bought at a price' shape how we treat our bodies?

Application - What will I do?

1. What do you need to 'flee' rather than flirt with?

2. How can you honor God with your body this week?

WORD STUDY

Purity

MEANING

Cleanness of heart and life; being undivided in devotion to God, including in thoughts, desires, and actions.

Where It Appears**MATTHEW 5:8**

"Blessed are the pure in heart, for they will see God."

PSALM 119:9

"How can a young person stay on the path of purity? By living according to your word."

Dig Deeper

1. Why does Jesus start purity in the heart, not just behavior?

2. How does God's word practically help with purity?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Battle

What desire is hardest for you to control?

What triggers tend to trip you up?

What boundaries or help do you need to put in place?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Guard Your Heart

Self-control grows with practical guardrails. Choose real ones.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Identify one trigger and remove or limit it this week.
- ☐ Ask a trusted friend or mentor to check in with you.
- ☐ Memorize one verse for moments of temptation.
- ☐ Replace a tempting habit with a healthy alternative.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 4

Humility and Handling Success

"Pride goes before destruction, a haughty spirit before a fall." - Proverbs 16:18

Unit Overview

Character is tested not only by failure but by success and attention. This unit explores humility, pride, and staying grounded.

DEVOTIONAL

Staying Grounded

It's easy to trust God when you're struggling. Success is the harder test of character.

1 PETER 5:6

"Humble yourselves, therefore, under God's mighty hand, that he may lift you up in due time."

Pride quietly takes credit and forgets God. Humility remembers where gifts come from.

Humility isn't thinking less of yourself; it's thinking of yourself less, and of God and others more.

Reflect

1. Where does pride sneak into your life - talents, looks, achievements?

2. How do you handle praise and attention?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, keep me humble in success and grounded in you.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

The Greatest Is the Servant

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

MARK 10:42-45

"Jesus called them together and said, 'You know that those who are regarded as rulers of the Gentiles lord it over them, and their high officials exercise authority over them. Not so with you. Instead, whoever wants to become great among you must be your servant, and whoever wants to be first must be slave of all. For even the Son of Man did not come to be served, but to serve, and to give his life as a ransom for many.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. How do worldly rulers act?

2. What is Jesus' definition of greatness?

3. What example does Jesus give?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

The Greatest Is the Servant

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Jesus flip the definition of greatness?

2. How is serving harder than ruling?

Application - What will I do?

1. Where do you want to be 'great,' and how could you serve there instead?

2. Who could you serve this week?

WORD STUDY

Humility

MEANING

A right view of yourself before God and others; freedom from pride that serves rather than seeks status.

Where It Appears**JAMES 4:6**

"God opposes the proud but shows favor to the humble."

PHILIPPIANS 2:3

"In humility value others above yourselves."

Dig Deeper

1. Why does God 'oppose the proud'?

2. How is humility different from insecurity or low self-worth?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Pride Check

Where are you tempted to take credit that belongs to God?

How do you respond to others' success?

What would humble confidence look like for you?

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Talk It Over

Pride hides well. Help each other see it.

1. Where does pride show up in students our age?

2. How can we celebrate others without jealousy?

3. What does servant leadership look like at school?

UNIT 5

Perseverance and Handling Failure

"Consider it pure joy... whenever you face trials of many kinds." - James 1:2

Unit Overview

Everyone fails. Character is shaped by how you respond. This unit is about resilience, repentance, and getting back up.

DEVOTIONAL

Getting Back Up

Failure isn't final unless you let it define you. Even David, Peter, and Paul failed badly and were restored.

PROVERBS 24:16

"For though the righteous fall seven times, they rise again."

The mark of the righteous isn't that they never fall; it's that they get back up, by grace.

God is not surprised by your failure and is not done with you because of it.

Reflect

1. What failure have you let define you?

2. What would 'rising again' look like from here?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, thank you that failure isn't final. Help me get back up.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Restored After Failure

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

JOHN 21:15-17

"When they had finished eating, Jesus said to Simon Peter, 'Simon son of John, do you love me more than these?' 'Yes, Lord,' he said, 'you know that I love you.' Jesus said, 'Feed my lambs.' Again Jesus said, 'Simon son of John, do you love me?' ... The third time he said to him, 'Simon son of John, do you love me?' Peter was hurt... He said, 'Lord, you know all things; you know that I love you.' Jesus said, 'Feed my sheep.'"

Observation - What does it say?

1. What had Peter done days earlier?

2. How many times does Jesus ask?

3. What does Jesus call Peter back to?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Restored After Failure

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why might Jesus ask three times?

2. What does this reveal about how God handles our failure?

Application - What will I do?

1. What failure do you need to hear Jesus restore?

2. What is he calling you back to?

WORD STUDY

Perseverance

MEANING

Steadfast endurance; continuing to trust and obey God through trials and setbacks.

Where It Appears**JAMES 1:12**

"Blessed is the one who perseveres under trial."

HEBREWS 12:1

"Let us run with perseverance the race marked out for us."

Dig Deeper

1. What is the difference between perseverance and stubbornness?

2. What trial is God using to build endurance in you?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

My Comeback

Write about a failure that still weighs on you.

What have you learned through it?

What would it look like to move forward with God?

APPLICATION CHALLENGE

Rise Again

Resilience is a practice, not a personality type. Try these.

This Week's Challenges

- ☐ Confess one failure to God and receive his forgiveness.
- ☐ Take one step to make right what you can.
- ☐ Reframe a failure as a lesson in writing.
- ☐ Encourage someone else who has stumbled.

What happened when you tried?

UNIT 6

A Character That Points to Christ

"In the same way, let your light shine before others." - Matthew 5:16

Unit Overview

This unit ties character to witness: the goal isn't just being a 'good person' but reflecting Jesus so others see him in you.

DEVOTIONAL

The Point of Character

Christian character isn't about earning a good reputation. It's about pointing to the One who changed you.

MATTHEW 5:16

"Let your light shine before others, that they may see your good deeds and glorify your Father in heaven."

Notice the goal: not that people praise you, but that they glorify God. Character is a signpost, not a spotlight.

The most powerful argument for Christ is often a life quietly transformed by him.

Reflect

1. Does your character point people to God or to yourself?

2. Where has God clearly changed you in a way others could notice?

PRAYER PROMPT

God, let my character point to you, not to me.

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - OBSERVE

Living Among Watchers

Read the passage slowly, more than once. First notice what it actually says before deciding what it means.

1 PETER 2:11-12

"Dear friends, I urge you, as foreigners and exiles, to abstain from sinful desires, which wage war against your soul. Live such good lives among the pagans that, though they accuse you of doing wrong, they may see your good deeds and glorify God on the day he visits us."

Observation - What does it say?

1. What are believers urged to abstain from?

2. How are we to live 'among' others?

3. What might result?

INDUCTIVE BIBLE STUDY - INTERPRET & APPLY

Living Among Watchers

Interpretation - What does it mean?

1. Why does Peter call us 'foreigners and exiles'?

2. How can good lives answer accusations?

Application - What will I do?

1. Who is watching your life right now?

2. What 'good deeds' could point them to God?

WORD STUDY

Witness

MEANING

A person whose life and words testify to the truth about Jesus.

Where It Appears

ACTS 1:8

"You will be my witnesses."

1 PETER 3:15

"Always be prepared to give an answer... for the hope that you have."

Dig Deeper

1. How does your life 'testify' before you ever say a word?

2. What 'hope' would you point to if someone asked?

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

The Legacy I'm Building

What kind of character do you want to be known for?

What has this study revealed you need to grow in?

Write a prayer about the person God is shaping you to be.

SMALL GROUP DISCUSSION

Commissioned

Final discussion. Character is a lifelong project.

1. Which area of character will you keep working on?

2. How can your character point others to Jesus?

3. How can this group keep each other accountable?

MEMORY & MEDITATION

Hide This Word in Your Heart

PSALM 15:2-4

"Psalm 15:2-4"

Context

Look back over the verses you studied in this book.

Why It Matters

Scripture memorized becomes a resource the Holy Spirit can bring to mind in real moments of decision, temptation, doubt, and encouragement.

Write It From Memory

LIVE IT OUT THIS WEEK

Choose one verse from this book to carry with you all week.

REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Memory Verse Review

Write out from memory: Psalm 15:2-4

Write out from memory: Proverbs 12:22

Write out from memory: 2 Timothy 1:7

Write out from memory: Proverbs 16:18

Write out from memory: James 1:2

SELF-ASSESSMENT

Spiritual Check-In

Rate each statement honestly. This is between you and God - there are no wrong answers, only honest starting points.

1 = rarely 5 = consistently

I make time to read the Bible on my own.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I pray about real things in my life, not just at meals.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I can explain what I believe and why.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I treat people the way Jesus would.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I invite God into my decisions before I make them.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I am honest even when it costs me.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I serve others without expecting anything back.

1	2	3	4	5
---	---	---	---	---

I go to God first when I am anxious or afraid.

1	2	3	4	5
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REFLECTION & JOURNAL

Final Reflection

Which area of character grew most through this study?

Where do you still need God's help?

Write a prayer committing your character to Christ.

NOTES

Study Notes

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